

UX IMPROVEMENT REPORT 001

Registration Form – Data Retention After Validation Error

REPORT OVERVIEW

- **Report ID:** UX-001
- **Module:** User Authentication – Registration
- **Category:** Usability / UX Improvement
- **Priority:** HIGH
- **Impact Area:** User Satisfaction & Conversion Rate
- **Status:** RECOMMENDED
- **Reported By:** Abdul Goni
- **Date:** December 29, 2025
- **Related Test Case:** TC-REG-004

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

When password validation fails during registration, the system clears **all input fields**, including First Name, Last Name, and Email, even though those values are valid.

While the validation logic functions correctly, this behavior introduces significant friction by forcing users to re-enter unrelated data, increasing frustration and abandonment risk.

Recommendation:
Retain all valid non-sensitive fields and clear only the field that failed validation (password).

CURRENT SYSTEM BEHAVIOR

Functional Status: WORKING AS DESIGNED

- Password length validation works correctly
- Error message is displayed near the password field
- Form submission is blocked
- User remains on registration page
- No system error or crash occurs

The issue is **not functional**, but **experiential**.

CURRENT USER EXPERIENCE (FAILED PASSWORD VALIDATION)

1. User fills all registration fields
2. Password does not meet minimum length
3. Error message is displayed
4. **All fields are cleared**
5. User must re-enter First Name, Last Name, Email, and Password again

This forces users to repeat work despite only one field being invalid.

UX ISSUES IDENTIFIED

1. Unnecessary Data Loss

- 75% of the entered data is valid but discarded
- Users lose non-sensitive information without reason

2. High Friction in a Critical Flow

- Registration is a high-effort, first-time interaction
- Clearing all fields creates strong frustration
- Particularly painful on mobile devices

3. Inefficient Error Recovery

- Users cannot immediately correct the password
- Risk of introducing new typos when re-entering data

4. Business Impact Risk

- Higher registration abandonment
- Lost user acquisition
- Negative first impression of product quality

PROPOSED IMPROVEMENT

Recommended Behavior After Validation Error

- Error message displayed near password field
- **First Name retained**
- **Last Name retained**
- **Email retained**
- **Password cleared**
- Cursor focus returns to password field

This allows users to immediately fix the issue without repeating unrelated input.

SECURITY & UX BALANCE

- Retaining non-sensitive fields does **not** introduce security risk
- Clearing the password maintains security best practices
- Aligns with standard behavior across modern web applications

EXPECTED BENEFITS

- Faster registration recovery
- Reduced frustration
- Improved conversion rate
- More predictable and user-friendly behavior
- Better alignment with industry UX standards

SUSPECTED ROOT CAUSE

- Global form reset triggered on validation error
- Lack of selective field retention logic

RELATED FINDINGS

- Similar UX issue identified in Login flow (UX-002)
- Suggests a system-wide form handling pattern

This report documents a UX improvement opportunity discovered during manual QA testing. The system behaves correctly from a functional standpoint, but improving data retention significantly enhances user experience and conversion potential.